

PRELUDE III

THE first 62 bars are in Double Counterpoint, at first in eight-bar phrases, then (with a new couple of themes) in four-bar phrases. In the first couple the crotchet-and-quaver theme has a much better swing when phrased bar by bar  than in the phrasing from quaver to crotchet. It should suggest dancing, not braying. In the second couple (bar 31 etc.) the downward octaves should be *staccato*, the remaining quavers *legato*, as will appear at once on the attempt to sing the figure.

From bar 63 the writing ceases to be contrapuntal and, except where the semiquavers go into runs, is not really two-part writing at all, but a compound of arpeggio and chord, lending itself to an exciting *crescendo* starting from *fp* in bar 63, and attaining a threatening and growing volume of tone at bar 87. Bars 83-86 should no longer be *staccato*, nor, indeed, should bars 75-76 be too dry.

When early key-board composers divide scales or arpeggios between two hands, as here from bar 97 onwards (or indeed throughout the previous passage), their object is never an antiphonal effect; on the contrary, they intend to secure smoothness and speed by putting the hands close together and avoiding the "passage of the thumb." (The exact technique has been ingeniously revived in Debussy's *Étude pour les huit doigts*). Hence there is very good reason here for following (as we do) the reading of the version in Friedemann Bach's *Clavierbüchlein*, where it omits the bass G# added in other autographs to bar 101; it being far better that the whole four bars 99-102 should float away as a single part before the full chords of the close. This close should not be much broadened; the slight broadening should begin in bar 102, and the quaver chords should be short and slightly broken. In other respects—viz., the form of the first couple of themes at bars 1 and 8—the other autographs are to be preferred. The *tempo* is as lively as clearness in the second couple of themes (bars 31 onwards) will permit.

FUGUE III

THIS Fugue is in Bach's typical key-board Triple Counterpoint, in which a lively Subject with strong rhythm and wide skips is combined with one Countersubject in flowing conjunct movement, and a second Countersubject in a few long notes forming suspensions (see bars 5-6). In such a combination all three will assert themselves clearly when the tone is evenly balanced; and in order to attain even balance on the pianoforte the sustained theme will demand the broadest *cantabile* touch. The Subject of the present Fugue comes out most clearly if the disjunct quavers (including the two in the fourth beat of the first bar) are *staccato*.

A.B. 99.

The Episodes contain much important new material. In Episode 1 (bars 7-9) the bass makes sequences of an inversion of the figure of the second bar of the first Countersubject, while the upper parts cross each other in an imitative dialogue on a new figure. It is important that this dialogue should sound like two parts, and not like one. This can be managed by bringing out only the upper part. The other will then be heard quite well as a fainter echo, and the interesting cross-rhythms and suspensions will become clear. With an even balance of tone these points are lost.

In Episode 2 (bars 12-13) the treble inverts the bass of Episode 1. In the left hand the measures just described are needed for the dialogue-figure, but it is the bass voice that should here be emphasised. Episode 3 (bars 16-18) is on the lines of Episode 1, with new upper parts arising from an incident in bar 9. The Subject and Countersubjects having appeared in E $\sharp$ minor, bars 21-22 come to a full close in that key (the shake suggested in brackets is a matter of course at such junctures). Episode 4 then develops on new lines (bars 23-24), combining the first figure of the Subject (which must be treated more lightly than real entries of the whole Subject) with the ubiquitous rolling figure of the other Episodes. Two more entries of the whole Subject-combination follow, in dominant and tonic. (It is notable that in the whole Fugue there are only two entries in other keys.) Episode 5 begins by reproducing Episode 2 with the treble transferred to the bass (bars 28-30). (The ornament here added in brackets is advisable by way of clinching the allusion.) From the middle of bar 30 to the end of bar 34 the dialogue-figure, now completely broken up and without any sustained notes, occupies the two lower parts. (One of these, preferably the bass, should still preponderate over the other to make the duet-character evident.) From bar 35 onwards the treble and bass alone work up a brilliant development of the special lines of Episode 4 with a new figure in the bass which, when the combination is reversed settles to a steady carillon in the treble. (The shake in bar 38 is best prolonged right into the ensuing semiquavers as if they were its natural finish.) Suddenly, in the middle of bar 42 the whole Subject reappears with the first Countersubject, and, being duly answered by the long rested middle part, initiates an entire Da Capo of the framework of the Exposition. An extra half-bar at the beginning of bar 48 brings into the tonic a recapitulation of Episode 1, leading to a final tonic entry of the Subject, and thus recapitulating (displaced by half a bar) the whole contents of bars 7-12. The interrupted cadence in bar 53 inaugurates the Coda and demands a slight broadening of the otherwise lively *tempo*, but not so much as would deprive the last bar of vigour. Note in that last bar the crossing of parts whereby the disjunct quavers of the Subject are expressed. The bracketed downward *arpeggio* represents the way in which such a point was made clear on the old instruments, and there is much to be said for adopting it on the pianoforte here, as Kroll suggests.

The discrepancies as to F $\times$ and F $\sharp$ in the First Countersubject are in accordance with most of the autographs, and Bach evidently does not care for uniformity on this point.